

Chapter

18

ORAL PRESENTATION

- *Introduction*
- *Preparing the Presentation*
- *Delivering the Presentation*
- *Methods of Delivering Oral Presentation*

Extemporaneous Method
Reading Method
Memorization Method
Impromptu Method

* How can we make our presentation effective?

* How noise create disturbance in our presentation?

* Time is an imp factor in presentation!

* Planning strategy.

Short Questions with Answers

What is purpose of ORAL PRESENTATION?

In the world of business, oral presentations are considered very important to communicate or deliver a message. Companies and business firms arrange oral presentations to achieve different goals and objectives. Sometimes these presentations are held to inform people about new products policies, or changes which take place. Sometimes business organizations arrange presentations to persuade people. And sometimes the purpose of a presentation is to entertain. To achieve these aims and objectives, the presenter must follow some steps and requirements at the time of preparing and delivering an oral presentation.

PLANNING THE PRESENTATION

While planning and preparing an oral presentation, one should keep the following steps in his mind so that he may well design the presentation. These steps are as follow:

- Know the purpose
- Assess the audience
- Collect the data
- Organize the data
- Prepare visual aids
- Rehearsal

i) **Know the Purpose**

*"To communicate, put your thoughts in order;
give them a purpose; use them to persuade,
to instruct, to discover"*

Before making an oral presentation, it is necessary to know and determine the purpose. This thing determines what to say and how to say. Generally, the purposes of an oral presentation are to inform, to persuade and to entertain. Sometimes the speaker tries to achieve one of these three purposes and sometimes a combination of these three purposes.

Let's discuss these three purposes in detail.

(a) **To inform:**

An informative speech conveys facts, using clear examples and supporting material. It aims to develop ideas, pass on information and show how something works or can be done. Balance the content and discussion to achieve an unbiased and objective presentation.

(b) To persuade

A persuasive speech establishes a need in the audience and explains the action required to satisfy the need. A persuasive speech aims to influence the audience, to change their attitude or bring them round to a particular point of view.

(c) To entertain

An entertaining speech uses a variety of techniques such as humour, ^{Short notes.} anecdotes, examples and quotations around a common theme so that the audience may enjoy the presentation. As a speaker, you may decide to combine informative or persuasive elements with entertainment.

Assess the Audience *v. Imp.*

Learning about your audience is of great importance. At the very least you need to give considerable thought to who these people are and what they are interested in and how you are going to hold their attention, while informing them about your topic. You may assess your audience by knowing age, sex, special interests and education level. If you do not know these details about your audience, you may make the mistake of providing them with the material that is too difficult or too basic, or that is entirely useless for their needs and interests.

Collect the Data and then arranging to your needs.

One of the most striking steps of an oral presentation is the collection of data. Collect the information which you consider related to your topic. For collecting data you may use different channels like using internet, conducting interviews, reading previous reports and meeting people. Do use your own knowledge as well.

Organize the Data

Organization of data is a very important step while planning a presentation. Construct your outline on paper. The order in which you present your ideas is as important as the ideas themselves. Disorganized and scattered ideas often confuse the listener and

make your presentation unimportant. Therefore, presentation of ideas requires good arrangement and logical connection and a proper structure.

iii) Prepare Visual Aids

Visual aids greatly enhance any presentation. The use of visual aids adds quality to your presentation. The presentation gets ^{shine}luster and becomes lively. In many instances visuals can add clarity and make the talk impactful. Since more sensory perceptions are put to use, the audience will have greater retention of information. The visual aids can be broadly classified as *static* and *dynamic*.

Static visual aids don't change but remain the same. For example flipcharts, posters, overheads etc.

Dynamic visual aids are those which move and change as the presentation proceeds. For example animated computer graphics, videos, actual objects etc.

iv) Rehearsal

Undoubtedly, 'practice makes a man perfect'. Do rehearse the things before going in front of your audience. The audience judges the speaker by his attitude, body language, tone of voice and style. You must know your opening sentence word for word. You must be sure that you can deliver the message within the time limit and all these above mentioned factors can only be achieved by rehearsal.

DELIVERING THE PRESENTATION

Having prepared the presentation, the time comes of its delivery. It is a very important stage which determines success or failure of a presentation. While delivering the presentation, the presenter must keep the following points in his mind.

i) Confidence

Confidence is the most important thing which a person needs to face an audience. It helps you to win people and persuade them. While standing in front of an audience, confidence helps you to convey and transmit your ideas in a proper way. This is the key element through which you can convince people. Confidence can generally be achieved through your grasp over the topic.

ii) Appearance. 90% of appearance is matter.

At the time of delivering a presentation, your appearance plays a

vital role to make others believe that you have the ability to something. A well and neatly dressed person leaves a good impact on the mind of audience and he succeeds to get the attraction of the audience.

iii) **Eye Contact**

The importance of eye contact is ^{very important} paramount. By keeping a good eye-contact with your audience, you leave a good impression. If you are shy and don't look at the audience, they will not pay interest and attention to your words.

iv) **Voice Quality**

The role of your voice is of great importance. Particularly at the time of delivering the presentation your voice should not be too low or too high but you must be ^{قابل سنا} audible to everyone. Your tone should be cheerful and it should never be unpleasant.

v) **Posture**

The way people stand or sit can say a lot of how they feel. The posture of a person projects his personality as well as his inner strength or weakness. It leaves a strong impression on the minds of the listeners when the speaker is alone standing whereas a good number of people look at him.

vi) **Word Rate**

Our thinking capacity is much higher than our speaking capacity. While talking to people, a person should not speak too fast or too slow. The accepted rate that our senses may accept easily is 80 to 160 words per minute. The speaker must keep this figure in his mind.

vii) **Pronunciation**

Pronunciation is a striking feature of an oral presentation. If you don't pronounce the words properly, your whole effort goes waste. Wrong pronunciation leaves a bad impact on the audience, and develops a humorous and non serious atmosphere among the listeners.

METHODS OF DELIVERING ORAL PRESENTATION

There are four methods of delivering oral presentation.

- I- Extemporaneous Method
- II- Manuscript – Reading Method
- III- Memorization Method
- IV- Impromptu Method

I Extemporaneous Method

In this method the speaker communicates on the groundwork of pre-planned outlines or notes. The outlines are supported with comments, quotations, statistics, facts, figures, and other relevant data.

II Reading Method

The speaker reads out manuscript of his speech. While reading out his speech the speaker often looks at his audience. Sometimes he may speak out of written manuscript to emphasize and elaborate some points.

III Memorization Method

Here the speaker communicates by memory. He speaks spontaneously. Before he delivers the speech he has the theme of the message. He explains and elaborates the points he has memorized. The speaker may sound like a parrot. It will create an awkward situation if he forgets a line or a word. He may slip up, have the slip of the tongue, or skip over some useful points.

IV Impromptu Method

On the spur of moment, without preparation, as the expediency demands, the speaker communicates. Impromptu refers to without preparation, improvised or off hand. Often in discussion, meetings or conferences people are asked to speak impromptu i.e., on the spur of the moment.

AUDIENCE ANALYSIS

Audience analysis is the process of examining information about your listeners. That analysis helps you to adapt your message so that your listeners will respond as you wish.

IMPORTANCE OF AUDIENCE ANALYSIS

Audience is center to the communication process. The purpose of communication is to transfer the message with transmission of understanding among the audience. Therefore good communication is always audience-centered. It is the audience that determines how one achieves the objectives of communication.

Therefore, an audience analysis is essential before designing the message. Communication can take place only when the message is received in the same sense and spirit that sender intends to carry. Therefore, the sender

as to devise some common ground between him and the audience. He has to choose the information that audience needs and finds interesting. He should encode the message in words and other symbols that audience will understand easily. Lastly, he should transmit the message along a channel that the audience will attend to.

Audience analysis contributes a lot the success of any message: to capture and hold an audience's attention and to motivate readers and listeners. You must shape and tailor your message to meet the audience's goals, interests, and needs.

According to *Kitty O. Locker*

"Understanding your audience is fundamental to the success of any message. You need to adapt your message to fit the audience's goals, interests and needs."

In everyday conversations you adapt your message to your audience. For example, if you went to a party the night before, you would explain the party differently to your friends and family. To your best friend you might say, "We partied all night and there were tons of people there." To your mother you might say, "Oh, I had fun with my friends." And to your significant other you might say, "It was fun, I had a great bonding time with my friends." In each of these situations, you are adapting your message to your listening audience.

When we analyze our audience, there are three ways to do this; **demographic analysis, attitudinal analysis, and environmental analysis.**

Demographic Analysis involves age, gender, culture, ethnicity, race, religion, and educational level. Aristotle noted more than 2,000 years ago that few things affect a person's outlook more than his or her age.

As college students we watch the same kinds of shows and listen to the same types of music and have a common history. These are all things that we have in common. If I were to do a speech about any one of these topics, I know that I may not have to explain who or what to an audience of my own age. Age is a very important factor and can be very helpful in picking a topic.

Gender is another characteristic. It is important to find out the ratio of men to women in the class. Also, make sure that you do not use any sexist language, stereotypes or make jokes about gender. If you were to insult men in front of a class of 12 men, then in most cases these 12 men

are not going to listen to you for the rest of your speech. You may have also lost your credibility.

Culture is the shared knowledge, behavior, attitudes, beliefs, values, and norms of a group. It is very important to be sensitive to students of other culture's feelings. You may do or say something that may offend them.

Ethnicity is a person's national or religious heritage. There may be a student from China Town in Chicago, or a student from Little Italy in New York. A person's **race** is a person's biological heritage. It is important to learn as much as possible about these students before your speech, so you are sure not to offend them or anger them.

Another touchy subject is **religion**. Be very careful when you speak about different religions because people feel very strongly about their beliefs.

And finally, the **education** background of your listeners can help your choice of vocabulary, language style, and your use of examples. This can help you select and narrow your topic.

Sample Demographic Analysis Questions

- What is the age of people in the audience?
- Are there significant cultural differences within the audience?
- What is the educational level of the audience?
- How many males and females are there in the audience?

Attitudinal Analysis addresses the audience's **attitudes, beliefs, and values**.

- An **attitude** defines what a person likes or dislikes. When you choose a topic, it is important to find out your audience's attitudes toward the subject. If you are doing a speech on rap, does your audience like rap?
- A **belief** is what you believe to be true or false. You may believe that rap is destroying the minds of young teenagers.
- And a **value** is "a person's beliefs or standards."⁽⁴⁾ You may value the future and the young minds that will be running the future. It is very important to find out before your speech what people's attitudes are about your subject. If you know these three things, it will be much easier to bring your audience to the responses that you want.

Sample Attitudinal Analysis Questions

- What are the audience's beliefs, and attitudes, toward the topic?
- What are the relevant audience values and motives in regard to this topic?

Environmental Analysis is finding out things like the seating arrangement, the number of people likely to attend, and the room lighting. The way the seats are arranged will affect the audience's response. It is also important to know how many people will be there for the speech. And the way the room is lighted will affect the way the audience responds. If it is dark and the speaker is showing overheads, there will not be conversation. But if the room is light and open, the audience may feel more free to talk. The seating arrangement, the number of people and the room lighting are all factors that will affect the speech.

Sample Environmental Analysis Questions

- How many will be in the audience?
- How will the seating be arranged?
- Will there be a podium? a microphone?
- Will there be noise and distractions?
- Will I have access to A.V. equipment?

Obviously, when thinking about what kind of topic you are going to select, it is compulsory for you to keep your audience in mind. Not doing so will put your speech at risk of not corresponding with the information needs of your audience and further jeopardize your credibility as a speaker. In sum, this information equips you with the foundational knowledge and skill-set required to ensure that your topic complements your audience. And, after all, if we are not adapting to meet the needs of our audience, we are not going to be informative or convincing speakers.

AUDIENCE ANALYSIS FACTORS

Audience expectations

When people become audience members in a speech situation, they bring with them expectations about the occasion, topic, and speaker. The speaker must mention their expectations and make them understand that he has the knowledge of the situation.

Knowledge of topic

Audience knowledge of a topic can vary widely on any given occasion, therefore, communicators should find out what their audience already knows about the topic. Never overestimate the audience's knowledge of a topic. The presenter must give a brief review of key term and concepts at the beginning of a speech to refresh memories without being patronizing.

Attitude toward topic

Knowing audience members' attitudes about a topic will help a speaker determine the best way to reach their goals. Imagine that a presenter is trying to convince the community to build a park. A speaker would probably be inclined to spend the majority of the speech giving reasons why a park would benefit the community.

Q.1
Ans.**Audience size**

Many elements of speech-making change in accordance with audience size. In general, the larger the audience the more formal the presentation should be. Sitting down and using common language when speaking to a group of 10 people is often quite appropriate. If you are speaking to 1,000 people, you often require that you use a microphone and speak from an elevated platform.

Q.2
Ans.**Demographics**

The demographic factors of an audience include age, gender, religion, ethnic background, class, sexual orientation, occupation, education, group membership, and countless other categories. Since these categories often organize individual's identities and experiences, a wise speaker attends to the them.

Setting

The setting of a presentation can influence the ability to give a speech and the audience's ability and desire to listen. Some of these factors are: the set-up of the room (both size and how the audience is arranged), time of day, temperature, external noises (lawn mowers, traffic), internal noises (babies crying, hacking coughs), and type of space (church, schoolroom, outside).

Q.3
Ans.**Voluntariness**

Audiences are either voluntary, in which case they are genuinely interested in what a presenter has to say, or involuntary, in which case they are not inherently interested in the presentation. Knowing the difference will assist in establishing how hard a speaker needs to work to spark the interest of the audience.

Q.4
Ans.**Egocentrism**

Most audience members are egocentric: they are generally most interested in things that directly affect them or their community. An effective speaker must be able to show their audience why the topic they are speaking on should be important to them.

Q.5
Ans.Q.6
Ans.Q.7
Ans.

SHORT QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

1 **What is an oral presentation?**

Ans. Oral presentation is a part of communication. It is as important as the written presentation. It is an art of expressing one's ideas completely and successfully before the audience.

2 **What are the essential steps/stages of oral presentation?**

Ans. There are six steps to prepare the oral presentation. These are as under:

- i. Determine the purpose of speech
- ii. Analyze the audience and the situation
- iii. Research the topic thoroughly
- iv. Organize the data and write the draft
- v. Make arrangements for visual aids, if required
- vi. Do the rehearsal

Q.3 **What is the methodology of speeches?**

Ans. There are four methods to make oral presentations.

- i. Extemporaneous method
- ii. Manuscript-reading method
- iii. Memorization method
- iv. Impromptu method

Q.4 **Explain extemporaneous method.**

Ans. It means to make the speech from a prepared outline. The speaker should type or print all essential points and headings on the paper in the form of outlines.

Q.5 **Explain memorization method.**

Ans. Memorization means learning by heart. Some speakers memorize their speeches and deliver them to the audience.

Q.6 **Define manuscript-reading method.**

Ans. Under this method, the speaker reads the points of his speech from the manuscript that he has prepared.

Q.7 **What is impromptu method?**

Ans. Impromptu mean without rehearsal or preparation. Often in

discussion, meetings or conferences people are asked to speak impromptu i.e., on the spur of the moment.

Q.8 Which points should be kept in mind while giving an oral presentation?

Ans.

- i. Appearance
- ii. Posture
- iii. Eye contact
- iv. Voice
- v. Audience
- vi. Preparation